

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1132

By Gant

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Novella Morrow on the occasion of her 102nd birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Novella Morrow will celebrate her 102nd birthday on April 17, 2026, a milestone that will be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, the daughter of L.B. Avant and Darlene Avant, Novella Morrow was born in the Ames Plantation community; and

WHEREAS, Mother Novella Morrow is the fifth of nine children, six of whom are deceased; her siblings who are still living include Ida Lee Peeler and Melroy Avant, and her deceased siblings are Everlyn Waddell, Willie B. Avant, Emma Sue Smith, Elizabeth Scott Heard, Ocdell Hussey, and Ellie B. Anderson; and

WHEREAS, Mother Morrow was married to the late A.D. Morrow for fifty years; she has three children, Mary, Mattie, and Margaret; her four grandchildren are Pamela, Kimberly, Tyrone, and Quartella (Nicolas); her seven great-grandchildren are Brandon (Shay), Bria (Jay), Paige, Nicolas, Jr., Anterrious (Aerial), Antonio, and Anterrica; and her six great-great-grandchildren are Karson, Ari, Tvarsky, King, Kadence, and Korbin; and

WHEREAS, Mother Morrow was baptized at an early age at Jones Chapel Missionary Baptist Church under the leadership of Pastor Robert Branch; and

WHEREAS, today, Mother Morrow faithfully attends Sunday School, is an active member of the Mother Board, and regularly attends the Fayette County Commission on Aging Center; and

WHEREAS, Mother Morrow, throughout her life, has exemplified true Christian character: a quiet spirit, love, joy, peace, kindness, goodness, and meekness. She is so faithful that she has never missed a church event. She loves traveling and enjoying herself; and

WHEREAS, as she enjoys this great milestone in her life, Mother Morrow continues to be a blessing to her family and the Jones Chapel Church family; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Novella Morrow on the occasion of her 102nd birthday and extend to her our warmest wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.